Q25: Comprehension Check

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Comprehension check. A team uses model A to generate training data *and* model A (same model) to judge which generated answers are best, then fine-tunes model B on the winners and reports that B improved—as scored by model A. Name the specific risk in this setup and one change that would make the reported improvement more trustworthy.

Answer. The risk is **circularity / self-preference bias** (a form of reward hacking): because the same model generates the data and judges quality, its own stylistic biases are baked into both the training signal and the evaluation, so B can score well on A's judgments without genuinely improving on what humans care about—an illusory gain (and, over iterations, a path toward model collapse). A trustworthy change: evaluate B on an *independent*, human-labeled held-out set (or at least a different judge model and fresh real data), decoupling the generator from the evaluator.